

8.1 A Short History Lesson

A turning point in what Internet video is today is, surprisingly, the leaked Paris Hilton video. The night-mode shot video of the ravishing heiress and her ex-boyfriend doing... err... stuff, showed the true potential of the equation Video + Internet = Fame. Effectively, Paris Hilton, a previously-unknown model with all the talent of a happy chimpanzee became famous, made a reality show, acted in a couple of movies, and recently released a music album. All this just by doing the nasty on tape.

Hilton was one of the first new-generation “Internet Phenomena.” True, she had rich parents and a body that only gestures can convey, but one can get famous quick even without those very useful things. The concept of these phenoms is quite like that of bad news—it spreads fast, and everyone wants to know about it. Take the case of the (in)famous *Numa Numa* dance. If the words “What was that?” flashed in your head, shame on you. Go stand in the corner for five minutes and then Google it. You will witness possibly the funniest fun that one has ever made of oneself. In his hilarious take on the Romanian song *Dragostea din Tei*, Gary Brolsma (the protagonist of the video) takes webcam descriptiveness to a whole new level. You have to watch the video to believe it. The podgy 20-year-old shows you why it’s cool to be horizontally challenged and flexibly gifted.

The video, first published by Brolsma himself on the Newsgroups (www.newsgroups.com) Web site has seen over 13 million views!



Gary getting jiggy with it